ChatDOC Tutorial

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1 What is ChatDOC ?

As of the time of this writing in November 2023, ChatDOC is the best research tool available to chat with documents and quickly extract, locate and summarize information without needing to waste your time reading information that is not relevant for you. It's the perfect AI reading assistant to speed up your research and knowledge, as it's aimed at researchers, students and knowledge workers. You can chat with individual files or collections with up to 30 files and you can ask the AI chatbot for suggested and custom queries, multi-doc questions to contrast information across files, and your own questions about the full text or a selected text from the file. It supports PDFs including scanned documents using OCR technology, DOC(X)s, EPUBs, TXTs, Markdown files, and websites.

You will get in-text citations and references in all ChatDOC's replies so you will be able to trace where the information is coming from and ensure the accuracy of the responses. In addition to that, you can start a thread within your chat to ask follow-up questions. You can summarize and analyze data from not only texts but tables and mathematical problems as well, to make their interpretation easier. You can also ask a file a question in any language and select in what language you want the answer to be, it's irrelevant the language in which the document is written, and you can always download and share your chats. Overall, ChatDOC is an essential tool for any researcher.

There is a quite limited Free plan, but there is a generous Pro subscription for under $60 if you pay annually and also the possibility to expand your plan if you need more pages or if you want to use GPT-4. Check out their website: ChatDoc

2 Use Cases of ChatDOC

1. **Summarize** and **get to understand** any **text**, **table** or **mathematical problem** and **get answers** in text, bullet point, or tabular format.
2. **Digest research papers and books**.
3. Get an **abstract**.
4. Filter the information and sources that aren't useful for your purposes.
5. Find information within a document.
6. **Fact-check** and **contrast views** from different authors.
7. **Paraphrase** selected sentences and change their tone.

8. **Translate selected texts**.
9. Critically challenge interpretations.
10. Brainstorm creative and interdisciplinary angles to improve your research.
11. Come up with ideas for attractive titles, keywords, and tags.
12. Get **feedback** for editing.

3 Tips to use ChatDOC effectively

- ***Ask one question at a time.*** If you ask many questions at the same time, the amount of information ChatDOC will provide for each question will decrease, and some questions might be ignored altogether.
- ***Avoid broad questions.*** If you ask broad questions like "summarize this entire book" or "find all the typos in this document", it will be impossible for ChatDOC to give an appropriate answer due to token input and output limits (in GPT 3.5 that's around 3000 words per turn combining input and output). Other kinds of broad questions like "what are the issues of this report?" won't work either because we are not providing any specific criteria.

4 ChatDOC use case

1. Open the chatDOC official website https://chatdoc.com/.
2. Click here and select any scientific paper from your computer :

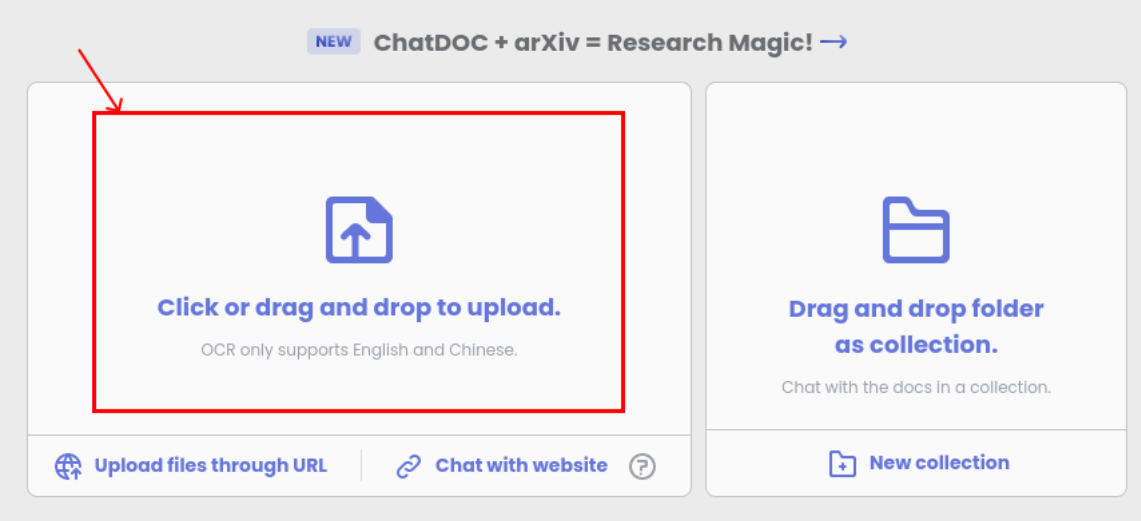


Figure 1: Upload a document

3. ChatDOC will automatically generate an abstract for you and suggest five questions. Generally, the suggested questions are very pertinent.

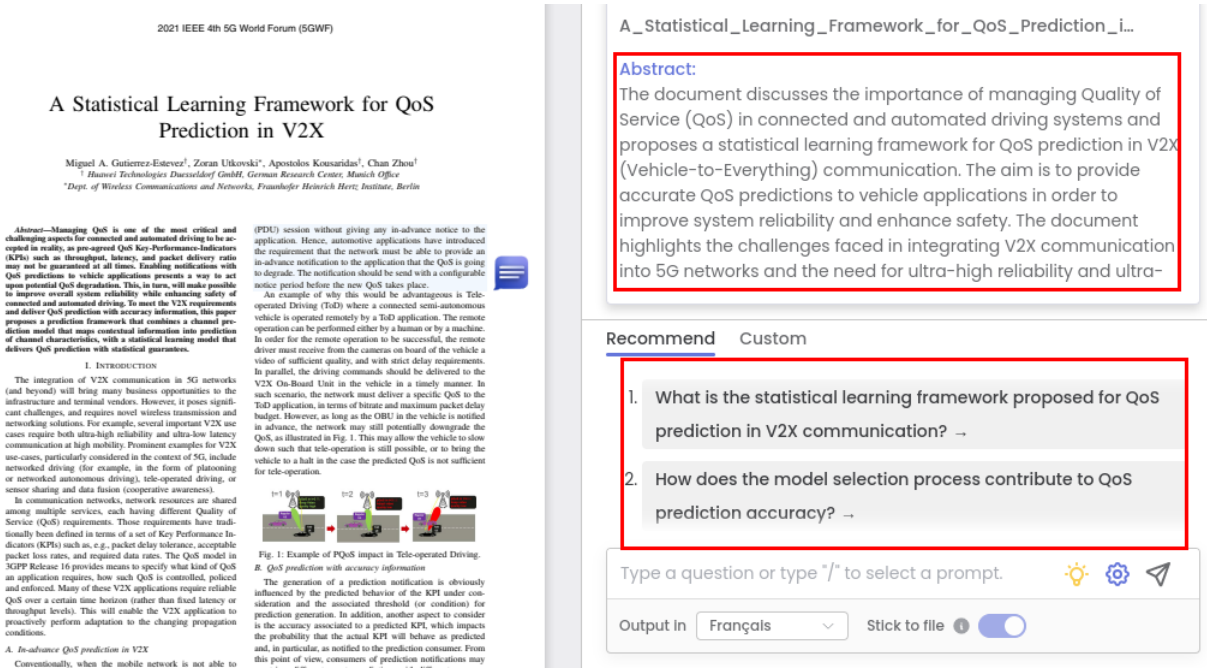


Figure 2: Abstract and suggested questions

4. Begin by posing targeted questions about the information you need, such as whether the article includes details on X or employs methodology Y. This approach assists in swiftly filtering out articles that may not align with your specific interests.

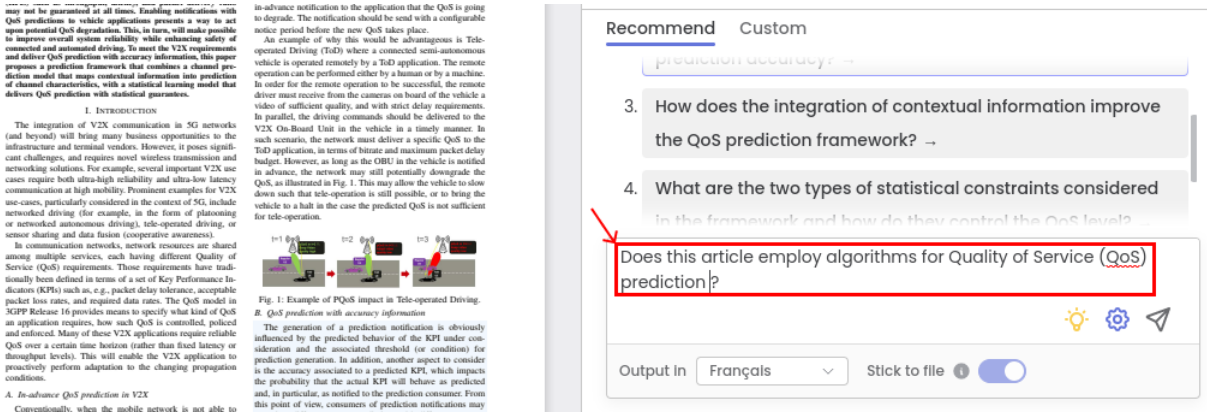


Figure 3: Ask specific questions

5. Highlight a text or a table, click the button with ChatDOC's logo next to it, and ask your question. This is the best way to get a relevant answer. You can use this feature to request simplification of unclear sections, seek summarization and interpretation of a table, and more.

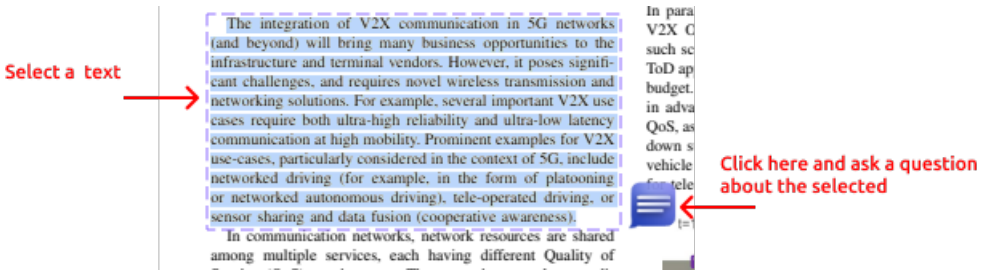


Figure 4: Ask about selected content

6. No matter the language of the document, you can ask a question in the language you choose and get the answer in the language you have defined as the output language for ChatDOC. In this example, the article is in English, I've asked a question in Arabic, and selected the output to be in French.



Figure 5: Translate